

Make technology “transparent”

Your app should just work. You can enhance it with instant notifications, geolocation, beautiful web fonts, drag-and-drop and high quality graphics but also these should be integrated in the experience you offer, rather than being exposed separately to users. For example, Weather Underground gives users information about the weather conditions in their area using geolocation, without asking users to take any action to enable this feature.

Invest in design

If you have 10 apps to choose from to, let's say, manage your Twitter updates, how do you select one to use? Most users often make their decisions based on the design quality of an app. With apps in Chrome you can create a rich user experience:

- ▶ **Big screen:** Unlike apps for a mobile device, apps in Chrome have access to larger screen real estate. With all the extra space, instead of shrinking the normal browser view with cluttered information, you can present your user with information that is spaced out and pleasant to access.
- ▶ **New tools:** You now have a rich array of options for designing and authoring highly graphical and beautiful applications. Most modern browsers support SVG, canvas, CSS3 transforms and animations, new colour models, integrated native video, and professional fonts. Because these building blocks are all native to the browser, it is very easy to combine them for greater effect. For example, you can add rounded corners to video or make a CSS animation that uses new colour schemes.
- ▶ **Innovation:** A web app is completely different from the usual pattern of a logo in the header, menu on the side, detail links in the footer, and so on. Clear your mind of all website designs and stress on user requirements; even better, think about how you'd want an app like that to look and feel like.

Don't forget usability

A good web app puts a premium on aesthetics without sacrificing usability. Specifically, a user expects to be within the web app, with all UI elements dedicated to the task at hand. The app exists in its own context and navigation scheme, and is external and independent from another website's context or navigation scheme.